Designing the Retail AI Companion

Revolutionizing the in-store experience through human-centric AI.

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Agenda

1. Mission

2. Vision

3. What are we solving

3. Designing for Patterns, Not Pages (The "Why")

2. The Chatbot as a Pattern: Beyond the "Bubble"

3. The Rep Pilot: Validation in the Wild

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Retail AI Mission

AI — Empowering Our Reps

Technology should support, not replace, the human touch. By equipping our retail floor with AI, we turn every rep into an expert, simplifying complex tasks and allowing our team to focus on what matters most: **the customer.**

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Retail AI Vision

AI — The Rep's Digital Partner

To create a future where Verizon reps are instantly empowered with universal product expertise via advanced AI, delivering effortlessly personalized and deeply meaningful **customer connections** that remove all friction and redefine the standard of **human-centric retail service**.

Findings to be Solved

AI — Streamlining Service to Maximize Sales Intent

Capturing Hidden Sales Opportunities

61.7% of interactions are labeled "Service", yet **27.6%** of those customers actually convert to sales.

Eliminating the Billing "Time-Trap"

31.1% of all in-store visits are for **Bill Inquiries** – the #1 non-sales driver. Reps spend excessive time manually deconstructing bills while sales opportunities slip away.

Reducing Cognitive & Information Overload

80% of customers expect immediate answers, but reps struggle with complex promos (touching **56.59%** of entries). This leads to hesitation and lost customer trust.

Streamlining Combo Orders

1.6M orders are abandoned during the fulfillment phase. Disconnects between digital intent and POS systems lead to transaction friction and lost revenue.

Shift the retail floor from **61.7% Service-Heavy** to a **Sales-First** environment by automating manual data retrieval.

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Designing for Patterns, Not Pages (The "Why”)

Designing for Patterns: The Speed of Sale

- **Cognitive Load:** Standardizing how data is presented (summaries, alerts, and recommendations) so reps don't have to "re-learn" the interface for different tasks.
- **Scalability:** Moving beyond bespoke screens to a "Lego-block" system where Billing, Account, and Product agents live in a shared UI framework.
- **The "Zero-Search" Workflow:** How we design UI patterns that deliver SKU and spec data faster than a veteran rep can recall it.
- **Reducing Cognitive Load:** Even great reps hit a wall with **56.59%** of customers asking about complex promos. We need patterns that "pre-digest" these rules so the rep can stay in the flow of the conversation.

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Using Agent Assist to further identify Pattern: Beyond the "Bubble"

The Chatbot as a "Pro-Active" Pattern

- **Beyond Assistance:** Moving from a "Help" bot to a **Sales Co-Pilot**.
- **Intent-Based Triggers:** The agent shouldn't wait to be asked. It should surface the "Best-Fit" recommendation based on the customer's HPU (High Propensity to Upgrade) status as a persistent UI element.
- **Deconstructing the Chatbot:** Moving away from traditional "message bubbles" toward **Integrated Intent Cards.**
- **Contextual Presence:** Discussing where the "Chatbot" lives—is it a persistent side rail, a hover-state, or an overlay?
- **Actionable Intelligence:** Ensuring the "Pattern" isn't just text, but contains **deep-linked actions** (e.g., a "Fix Bill" button or "Apply SKU" card).

OMNI Agent Assistant features / intents

Figma Flows

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The Rep Pilot: Validation in the Wild

. The Pilot: Stress-Testing High-Value Scenarios

- **Why Pilot with Experts?** To see if the AI Companion helps our best reps close **complex** multi-line or promo-heavy deals even faster.
- **Success Metrics:**
  - **Attach Rate Increase:** Does instant spec access lead to more accessories or protection plans?
  - **Transaction Velocity:** How much faster can a "Great Rep" finish a complex billing explanation and move to the next sale?

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Retail Pilot | 2026 Roadmap (April)

AI — The Foundation of Rep Companion

Week 1 | **Week 2** | **Week 3**

Pilot Planning

- Define pilot scope and success criteria
- Identify pilot stores or rep groups
- GTS and Design working session
- Recruit 4–6 store reps for design workshops

Deliverables

- Pilot success metrics
- Scenario test scripts
- Rep onboarding materials

Prototype ready for workshop

Working Session 1 – Rep discovery

Participants: 4–6 store reps, product, UX, AI team

Duration: 2–3 hours

Goal

Understand how reps sell today and where an AI companion would help most.

Prototype Updates & Scenario development

- Update AI companion prototype
- Implement top workflows discovered in workshop
- Prepare demo scenarios

Working Session 2 – Prototype testing

Participants: 4–6 store reps

Duration: 2–3 hours

Goal

Validate that the AI companion fits naturally into real rep conversations.

GTS delivery

Deploy tool to small rep group.

Reps use AI companion in real customer conversations.

Data Collected

-AI usage frequency

- recommendation acceptance
- conversation duration
- rep satisfaction

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Retail Pilot | 2026 Roadmap (April)

AI — The Foundation of Rep Companion

Week 1 | **Week 2** | **Week 3**

Leadership feedback

Jenny (VP and Above) a high level

This should have outcomes

Rep breakdown

Participants: 4–6 store reps, product, UX, AI team

1. One Assistant manager
2. One Store manager
3. Four reps

Rep breakdown

Participants: 4–6 store reps, product, UX, AI team

1. One Store manager Or Assistant manager
2. Five reps (1-2 the same rep)

Leadership Post-overview

Jenny (VP and Above) a high level

This should have outcomes

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Retail Pilot | 2026 Roadmap

AI — Working Session 1 – Rep discovery - Agenda

Week 1 | **Week 2** | **Week 3**

Context Setting (15 min)

Overview of AI Retail Companion vision
- Goals of the pilot

Current Sales Journey Mapping (30 min)

Reps map their typical process:
Customer enters store → discovery → plan recommendation → device → accessories → close.
Questions explored:
- Where do reps get stuck?- What information is hard to access?
- What slows down the conversation?

Pain Point Identification (30 min)

Examples reps usually surface:
- remembering plan details
- explaining complicated bills
- troubleshooting devices
- identifying the best bundle
- remembering promos

Opportunity Ideation (45 min)

Reps brainstorm where AI could help:
Examples:
- What plan should I recommend for this family?”
- “Explain this bill in simple terms”
- “Suggest accessories based on device”
- “Find upgrade opportunities”

Feature Prioritization (30 min)

Vote on highest value capabilities.
Typical Top Features:
1. Plan recommendation agent
2. Bill explanation agent
3. Troubleshooting agent
4. Cross-sell suggestions
5. Rep coaching tips

Deliverables

- Rep journey map
- Pain point list
- Feature prioritization matrix
- Real rep language for prompts

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Retail Pilot | 2026 Roadmap

AI — Prototype updates & Scenario development

Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3

Scenario 1

Plan Recommendation
Rep asks:
“Customer has 4 lines and travels internationally. What plan works best?”
AI response:
- Plan recommendation
- savings comparison
- upsell opportunities

Scenario 2

Bill Explanation
Rep uploads or enters bill summary
AI explains:
-charges
- promotions
- opportunities to optimize

Scenario 3

Troubleshooting Rep asks:
“Customer phone won’t connect to WiFi”
AI walks rep through steps.

Deliverables

- Updated prototype
- scenario scripts
- rep testing guide

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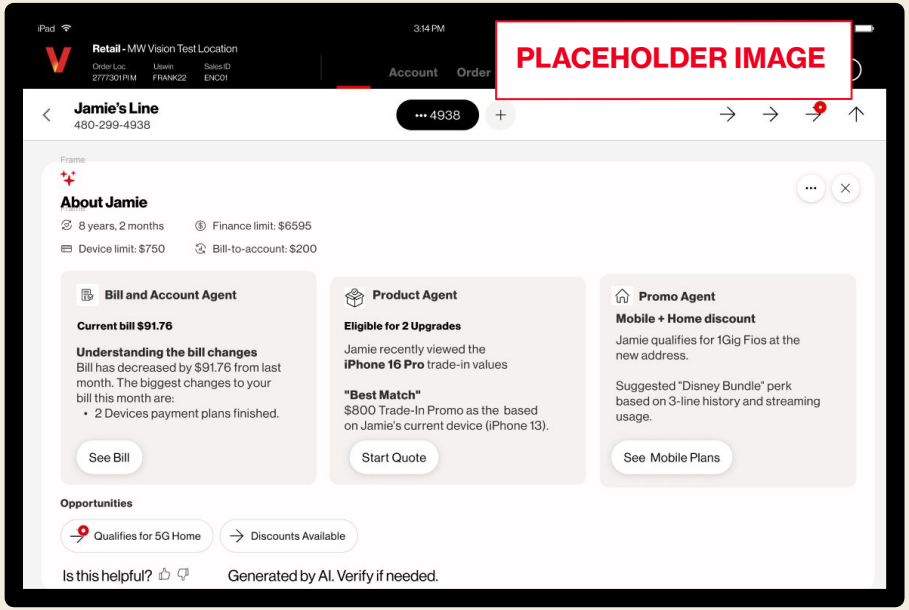
Meet the AI Companion

Interface | From Search to Orchestration | Agents

Standardizing Excellence on the Retail Floor.

The Retail AI Companion is a suite of integrated agents – Billing, Intent, and Product – designed to simplify the complex.

- **Eliminate the Learning Curve:** Moves reps from trainee to expert in hours, not weeks.
- **Instant Intent:** The rep knows *why* the customer is there before they even speak.
- **Data-Driven Recommendations:** Solves promo complexity for the **56.59%** of customers who need clarity on offers.



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Use case 1

The "Ecosystem Architect" (Multi-Plan Comparison Focus)

Scenario: A long-term customer (8+ years) like Jamie is eligible for a plan refresh and 5G Home integration.

- **Intent Agent:** Flags the customer as **HPU (High Propensity to Upgrade)** and notes they qualify for 5G Home internet.
- **Promo Agent:** Surfaces the **"Disney Bundle"** and **"Mobile + Home"** stackable discounts.
- **Action (Multi-Quote):** Instead of a single quote, the rep generates a **Side-by-Side Comparison**:
  - **Option A:** Current Mobile Plan + standalone Streaming Perks.
  - **Option B:** Integrated **Mobile + Home** bundle with the Disney Bundle included at a lower total monthly cost.

Outcome:

The rep uses the visual comparison to show the customer exactly how much they save by consolidating their services, making the "Yes" an easy decision.

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Use case 2

"Plan Optimization" Specialist (Billing Agent Focus)

Scenario:

A customer is concerned about a price increase on their monthly statement.

- **Intent Agent:** Identifies the "Why" immediately – e.g., a specific promotional credit on Line 2 has expired.
- **Billing Agent:** Summarizes the change (as seen in the "Understanding the bill changes" section) so the rep can explain it in seconds.

Outcome:

Instead of a 10-minute deep-dive into PDF pages, the rep quickly validates the change and immediately pivots to checking for new Mobile + Home discounts to offset the cost.

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Use case 3

"Technical Authority" (Product Agent Focus)

Scenario:

A customer is comparing the iPhone 16 Pro against their current device and is confused by the 56.59% of complex promos they saw online.

- **Product Agent:** Displays the "Best Match" SKU and exact trade-in values ($800) specifically for their current iPhone 13. It surfaces the specific storage and color inventory availability in real-time.
- **Intent Agent:** Pulls the customer's recent digital "views" so the rep can lead with: *"I see you were looking at the 16 Pro trade-ins; based on your device limit of $750, here is the most cost-effective way to upgrade today."*

Outcome:

The rep clicks **"Start Quote"** to instantly lock in the $800 trade-in value and move toward a close.

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